02 Exo · Exodus

1 These are the names of the sons of Israel who went to Egypt with Jacob,
each with his family: [2] Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah; [3] Issachar, Zebulun,
and Benjamin; [4] Dan and Naphtali; Gad and Asher. [5] The descendants of Jacob
numbered seventy in all, including Joseph, who was already in Egypt. [6] Now Joseph
and all his brothers and all that generation died, [7] but the Israelites were fruitful
and increased rapidly; they multiplied and became exceedingly numerous, so that
the land was filled with them. [8] Then a new king, who did not know Joseph, came
to power in Egypt. [9] "Look," he said to his people, "the Israelites have become too
numerous and too powerful for us." [10] "Come, let us deal shrewdly with them, or
they will increase even more; and if a war breaks out, they may join our enemies,
fight against us, and leave the country."

[11] So the Egyptians appointed taskmasters over the Israelites to oppress them with
forced labor. As a result, they built Pithom and Rameses as store cities for Pharaoh.
[12] But the more they were oppressed, the more they multiplied and flourished; so
the Egyptians came to dread the Israelites. [13] They worked the Israelites ruthlessly

[14] and made their lives bitter with hard labor in brick and mortar, and with all kinds
of work in the fields. Every service they imposed was harsh. [15] Then the king of Egypt
said to the Hebrew midwives, whose names were Shiphrah and Puah, [16] "When you
help the Hebrew women give birth, observe them on the birthstools. If the child
is a son, kill him; but if it is a daughter, let her live." [17] The midwives, however,
feared God and did not do as the king of Egypt had instructed; they let the boys live.
[18] So the king of Egypt summoned the midwives and asked them, "Why have you
done this? Why have you let the boys live?" [19] The midwives answered Pharaoh,
"The Hebrew women are not like the Egyptian women, for they are vigorous and
give birth before a midwife arrives." [20] So God was good to the midwives, and the
people multiplied and became even more numerous. [21] And because the midwives
feared God, He gave them families of their own. [22] Then Pharaoh commanded all
his people: "Every son born to the Hebrews you must throw into the Nile, but every
daughter you may allow to live."

2 Now a man of the house of Levi married a daughter of Levi, [2] and she conceived
and gave birth to a son. When she saw that he was a beautiful child, she hid him
for three months. [3] But when she could no longer hide him, she got him a papyrus
basket and coated it with tar and pitch. Then she placed the child in the basket and
set it among the reeds along the bank of the Nile. [4] And his sister stood at a distance
to see what would happen to him. [5] Soon the daughter of Pharaoh went down to
bathe in the Nile, and her attendants were walking along the riverbank. And when
she saw the basket among the reeds, she sent her maidservant to retrieve it. [6] When
she opened it, she saw the child, and behold, the little boy was crying. So she had
compassion on him and said, "This is one of the Hebrew children." [7] Then his sister
said to Pharaoh's daughter, "Shall I go and call one of the Hebrew women to nurse
the child for you?"

[8] "Go ahead," Pharaoh's daughter told her. And the girl went and called the
boy's mother. [9] Pharaoh's daughter said to her, "Take this child and nurse him for
me, and I will pay your wages." So the woman took the boy and nursed him. [10] When
the child had grown older, she brought him to Pharaoh's daughter, and he became
her son. She named him Moses and explained, "I drew him out of the water." [11] One
day, after Moses had grown up, he went out to his own people and observed their
hard labor. He saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew, one of his own people.

[12] After looking this way and that and seeing no one, he struck down the Egyptian
and hid his body in the sand. [13] The next day Moses went out and saw two Hebrews
fighting. He asked the one in the wrong, "Why are you attacking your companion?"
[14] But the man replied, "Who made you ruler and judge over us? Are you planning
to kill me as you killed the Egyptian?" Then Moses was afraid and thought, "This
thing I have done has surely become known." [15] When Pharaoh heard about this
matter, he sought to kill Moses. But Moses fled from Pharaoh and settled in the
land of Midian, where he sat down beside a well.

[16] Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters, and they came to draw water
and fill the troughs to water their father's flock. [17] And when some shepherds came
along and drove them away, Moses rose up to help them and watered their flock.
[18] When the daughters returned to their father Reuel, he asked them, "Why have
you returned so early today?" [19] "An Egyptian rescued us from the shepherds," they
replied. "He even drew water for us and watered the flock." [20] "So where is he?" their
father asked. "Why did you leave the man behind? Invite him to have something
to eat." [21] Moses agreed to stay with the man, and he gave his daughter Zipporah to
Moses in marriage. [22] And she gave birth to a son, and Moses named him Gershom,
saying, "I have become a foreigner in a foreign land." [23] After a long time, the king
of Egypt died. The Israelites groaned and cried out under their burden of slavery,
and their cry for deliverance from bondage ascended to God. [24] So God heard
their groaning, and He remembered His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.
[25] God saw the Israelites and took notice.

3 Meanwhile, Moses was shepherding the flock of his father-in-law Jethro, the
priest of Midian. He led the flock to the far side of the wilderness and came to
Horeb, the mountain of God. [2] There the angel of the LORD appeared to him in
a blazing fire from within a bush. Moses saw the bush ablaze with fire, but it was
not consumed. [3] So Moses thought, "I must go over and see this marvelous sight.
Why is the bush not burning up?" [4] When the LORD saw that he had gone over to
look, God called out to him from within the bush, "Moses, Moses!" "Here I am,"
he answered. [5] "Do not come any closer," God said. "Take off your sandals, for the
place where you are standing is holy ground." [6] Then He said, "I am the God of
your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob." At this,
Moses hid his face, for he was afraid to look at God.

[7] The LORD said, "I have indeed seen the affliction of My people in Egypt.
I have heard them crying out because of their oppressors, and I am aware of
their sufferings." [8] I have come down to rescue them from the hand of the Egyptians
and to bring them up out of that land to a good and spacious land, a land flowing
with milk and honey—the home of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites,
Hivites, and Jebusites. [9] And now the cry of the Israelites has reached Me, and I
have seen how severely the Egyptians are oppressing them. [10] "Therefore, go! I am
sending you to Pharaoh to bring My people the Israelites out of Egypt." [11] But
Moses asked God, "Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israelites
out of Egypt?" [12] "I will surely be with you," God said, "and this will be the sign to
you that I have sent you: When you have brought the people out of Egypt, all of
you will worship God on this mountain." [13] Then Moses asked God, "Suppose I go
to the Israelites and say to them, 'The God of your fathers has sent me to you,' and
they ask me, 'What is His name?' What should I tell them?"

[14] God said to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM. This is what you are to say to the
Israelites: 'I AM has sent me to you.'" [15] God also told Moses, "Say to the Israelites,
'The LORD, the God of your fathers—the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and
the God of Jacob—has sent me to you.' This is My name forever, and this is how I
am to be remembered in every generation."

[16] Go, assemble the elders of Israel and say to them, 'The LORD, the God of your
fathers—the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—has appeared to me and said: I
have surely attended to you and have seen what has been done to you in Egypt.'
[17] And I have promised to bring you up out of your affliction in Egypt, into the
land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites—a
land flowing with milk and honey.' [18] The elders of Israel will listen to what you
say, and you must go with them to the king of Egypt and tell him, 'The LORD, the
God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Now please let us take a three-day journey
into the wilderness, so that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.' [19] But I know
that the king of Egypt will not allow you to go unless a mighty hand compels him.
[20] So I will stretch out My hand and strike the Egyptians with all the wonders I will
perform among them. And after that, he will release you. [21] And I will grant this
people such favor in the sight of the Egyptians that when you leave, you will not
go away empty-handed. [22] "Every woman shall ask her neighbor and any woman
staying in her house for silver and gold jewelry and clothing, and you will put them
on your sons and daughters. So you will plunder the Egyptians."

4 Then Moses answered, "What if they do not believe me or listen to my voice?
For they may say, 'The LORD has not appeared to you.'" [2] And the LORD asked
him, "What is that in your hand?" "A staff," he replied. [3] "Throw it on the ground,"
said the LORD. So Moses threw it on the ground, and it became a snake, and he
ran from it. [4] "Stretch out your hand and grab it by the tail," the LORD said to
Moses, who reached out his hand and caught the snake, and it turned back into
a staff in his hand. [5] "This is so that they may believe that the LORD, the God
of their fathers—the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob—
has appeared to you." [6] Furthermore, the LORD said to Moses, "Put your hand
inside your cloak." So he put his hand inside his cloak, and when he took it out, his
hand was leprous, white as snow. [7] "Put your hand back inside your cloak," said the
LORD. So Moses put his hand back inside his cloak, and when he took it out, it was
restored, like the rest of his skin. [8] And the LORD said, "If they refuse to believe
you or heed the witness of the first sign, they may believe that of the second." [9] "But
if they do not believe even these two signs or listen to your voice, take some water
from the Nile and pour it on the dry ground. Then the water you take from the
Nile will become blood on the ground."

[10] "Please, Lord," Moses replied, "I have never been eloquent, neither in the past
nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech and tongue."
[11] And the LORD said to him, "Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute
or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?" [12] "Now go! I will help
you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say." [13] But Moses replied, "Please,
Lord, send someone else."

14 Then the anger of the LORD burned against Moses, and He said, "Is not Aaron
the Levite your brother? I know that he can speak well, and he is now on his way to
meet you. When he sees you, he will be glad in his heart." 15 You are to speak to him
and put the words in his mouth. I will help both of you to speak, and I will teach you
what to do. 16 He will speak to the people for you. He will be your spokesman, and
it will be as if you were God to him. 17 "But take this staff in your hand so you can
perform signs with it." 18 Then Moses went back to his father-in-law Jethro and said
to him, "Please let me return to my brothers in Egypt to see if they are still alive."
"Go in peace," Jethro replied. 19 Now the LORD had said to Moses in Midian, "Go
back to Egypt, for all the men who sought to kill you are dead."

20 So Moses took his wife and sons, put them on a donkey, and headed back to
Egypt. And he took the staff of God in his hand. 21 The LORD instructed Moses,
"When you go back to Egypt, see that you perform before Pharaoh all the wonders
that I have put within your power. But I will harden his heart so that he will not
let the people go." 22 Then tell Pharaoh that this is what the LORD says: 'Israel is
My firstborn son,' 23 "and I told you to let My son go so that he may worship Me.
But since you have refused to let him go, behold, I will kill your firstborn son!'"
24 Now at a lodging place along the way, the LORD met Moses and was about to
kill him. 25 But Zipporah took a flint knife, cut off her son's foreskin, and touched
it to Moses' feet. "Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me," she said. 26 So the
LORD let him alone. (When she said, "bridegroom of blood," she was referring
to the circumcision.) 27 Meanwhile, the LORD had said to Aaron, "Go and meet
Moses in the wilderness." So he went and met Moses at the mountain of God and
kissed him. 28 And Moses told Aaron everything the LORD had sent him to say,
and all the signs He had commanded him to perform. 29 Then Moses and Aaron
went and assembled all the elders of the Israelites, 30 and Aaron relayed everything
the LORD had said to Moses. And Moses performed the signs before the people,
31 and they believed. And when they heard that the LORD had attended to the
Israelites and had seen their affliction, they bowed down and worshiped.

5 After that, Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and said, "This is what the
LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may hold a feast to
Me in the wilderness.'" 2 But Pharaoh replied, "Who is the LORD that I should
obey His voice and let Israel go? I do not know the LORD, and I will not let
Israel go." 3 "The God of the Hebrews has met with us," they answered. "Please let
us go on a three-day journey into the wilderness to sacrifice to the LORD our God,
or He may strike us with plagues or with the sword." 4 But the king of Egypt said
to them, "Moses and Aaron, why do you draw the people away from their work?
Get back to your labor!" 5 Pharaoh also said, "Look, the people of the land are now
numerous, and you would be stopping them from their labor." 6 That same day
Pharaoh commanded the taskmasters of the people and their foremen: 7 "You shall
no longer supply the people with straw for making bricks. They must go and gather
their own straw." 8 But require of them the same quota of bricks as before; do not
reduce it. For they are lazy; that is why they are crying out, 'Let us go and sacrifice to
our God.' 9 "Make the work harder on the men so they will be occupied and pay no
attention to these lies." 10 So the taskmasters and foremen of the people went out
and said to them, "This is what Pharaoh says: 'I am no longer giving you straw.'"
11 "Go and get your own straw wherever you can find it; but your workload will in
no way be reduced.'"

12 So the people scattered all over the land of Egypt to gather stubble for straw.
13 The taskmasters kept pressing them, saying, "Fulfill your quota each day, just as
you did when straw was provided." 14 Then the Israelite foremen, whom Pharaoh's
taskmasters had set over the people, were beaten and asked, "Why have you not
fulfilled your quota of bricks yesterday or today, as you did before?"

15 So the Israelite foremen went and appealed to Pharaoh: "Why are you treating
your servants this way?" 16 "No straw has been given to your servants, yet we are
told, 'Make bricks!' Look, your servants are being beaten, but the fault is with your
own people." 17 "You are slackers!" Pharaoh replied. "Slackers! That is why you
keep saying, 'Let us go and sacrifice to the LORD.'" 18 "Now get to work. You will
be given no straw, yet you must deliver the full quota of bricks." 19 The Israelite
foremen realized they were in trouble when they were told, "You must not reduce
your daily quota of bricks." 20 When they left Pharaoh, they confronted Moses and
Aaron, who stood waiting to meet them. 21 "May the LORD look upon you and
judge you," the foremen said, "for you have made us a stench before Pharaoh and
his officials; you have placed in their hand a sword to kill us!" 22 So Moses returned
to the LORD and asked, "Lord, why have You brought trouble upon this people?
Is this why You sent me?" 23 "Ever since I went to Pharaoh to speak in Your name,
he has brought trouble on this people, and You have not delivered Your people in
any way."

6 But the LORD said to Moses, "Now you will see what I will do to Pharaoh, for
because of My mighty hand he will let the people go; because of My strong hand
he will drive them out of his land." 2 God also told Moses, "I am the LORD." 3 I
appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob as God Almighty, but by My name
the LORD I did not make Myself known to them. 4 I also established My covenant
with them to give them the land of Canaan, the land where they lived as foreigners.
5 Furthermore, I have heard the groaning of the Israelites, whom the Egyptians are
enslaving, and I have remembered My covenant. 6 Therefore tell the Israelites: 'I
am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the yoke of the Egyptians and
deliver you from their bondage. I will redeem you with an outstretched arm and
with mighty acts of judgment.' 7 I will take you as My own people, and I will be
your God. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God, who brought you
out from under the yoke of the Egyptians. 8 "And I will bring you into the land that
I swore to give to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. I will give it to you as a possession. I
am the LORD!'" 9 Moses relayed this message to the Israelites, but on account of
their broken spirit and cruel bondage, they did not listen to him.

10 So the LORD said to Moses, 11 "Go and tell Pharaoh king of Egypt to let the
Israelites go out of his land." 12 But in the LORD's presence Moses replied, "If the
Israelites will not listen to me, then why would Pharaoh listen to me, since I am
unskilled in speech?"

13 Then the LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron and gave them a charge concerning
both the Israelites and Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the Israelites out of the land
of Egypt.

14 These were the heads of their fathers' houses: The sons of Reuben, the
firstborn of Israel, were Hanoch and Pallu, Hezron and Carmi. These were the
clans of Reuben.

15 The sons of Simeon were Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul, the
son of a Canaanite woman. These were the clans of Simeon.

16 These were the names of the sons of Levi according to their records: Gershon,
Kohath, and Merari. Levi lived 137 years.

17 The sons of Gershon were Libni and Shimei, by their clans.

18 The sons of Kohath were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Kohath lived
133 years.

19 The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi. These were the clans of the Levites
according to their records.

20 And Amram married his father's sister Jochebed, and she bore him Aaron and
Moses. Amram lived 137 years.

21 The sons of Izhar were Korah, Nepheg, and Zichri.

22 The sons of Uzziel were Mishael, Elzaphan, and Sithri.

23 And Aaron married Elisheba, the daughter of Amminadab and sister of
Nahshon, and she bore him Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.

24 The sons of Korah were Assir, Elkanah, and Abiasaph. These were the clans
of the Korahites.

25 Aaron's son Eleazar married one of the daughters of Putiel, and she bore him
Phinehas. These were the heads of the Levite families by their clans. 26 It was this
Aaron and Moses to whom the LORD said, "Bring the Israelites out of the land of
Egypt by their divisions." 27 Moses and Aaron were the ones who spoke to Pharaoh
king of Egypt in order to bring the Israelites out of Egypt. 28 Now on the day that
the LORD spoke to Moses in Egypt, 29 He said to him, "I am the LORD; tell
Pharaoh king of Egypt everything I say to you." 30 But in the LORD's presence
Moses replied, "Since I am unskilled in speech, why would Pharaoh listen to me?"

7 The LORD answered Moses, "See, I have made you like God to Pharaoh, and
your brother Aaron will be your prophet." 2 You are to speak all that I command
you, and your brother Aaron is to tell Pharaoh to let the Israelites go out of
his land. 3 But I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and though I will multiply My signs
and wonders in the land of Egypt, 4 Pharaoh will not listen to you. Then I will lay
My hand on Egypt, and by mighty acts of judgment I will bring the divisions of
My people the Israelites out of the land of Egypt. 5 "And the Egyptians will know
that I am the LORD, when I stretch out My hand against Egypt and bring the
Israelites out from among them." 6 So Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD had
commanded them. 7 Moses was eighty years old and Aaron was eighty-three when
they spoke to Pharaoh.

8 The LORD said to Moses and Aaron, 9 "When Pharaoh tells you, 'Perform
a miracle,' you are to say to Aaron, 'Take your staff and throw it down before
Pharaoh,' and it will become a serpent." 10 So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh
and did just as the LORD had commanded. Aaron threw his staff down before
Pharaoh and his officials, and it became a serpent.

11 But Pharaoh called the wise men and sorcerers and magicians of Egypt, and they
also did the same things by their magic arts. 12 Each one threw down his staff, and it
became a serpent. But Aaron's staff swallowed up the other staffs. 13 Still, Pharaoh's
heart was hardened, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said.
14 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh's heart is unyielding; he refuses to let
the people go." 15 Go to Pharaoh in the morning as you see him walking out to the
water. Wait on the bank of the Nile to meet him, and take in your hand the staff
that was changed into a snake.

16 Then say to him, 'The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has sent me to tell you:
Let My people go, so that they may worship Me in the wilderness. But you have not
listened until now.' 17 This is what the LORD says: By this you will know that I am
the LORD. Behold, with the staff in my hand I will strike the water of the Nile,
and it will turn to blood. 18 "The fish in the Nile will die, the river will stink, and
the Egyptians will be unable to drink its water.'" 19 And the LORD said to Moses,

"Tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt —over their rivers and canals and ponds and reservoirs—that they may become blood.' There will be blood throughout the land of Egypt, even in the vessels of wood and stone." [20] Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD had commanded; in the presence of Pharaoh and his officials, Aaron raised the staff and struck the water of the Nile, and all the water was turned to blood. [21] The fish in the Nile died, and the river smelled so bad that the Egyptians could not drink its water. And there was blood throughout the land of Egypt. [22] But the magicians of Egypt did the same things by their magic arts. So Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said. [23] Instead, Pharaoh turned around, went into his palace, and did not take any of this to heart. [24] So all the Egyptians dug around the Nile for water to drink, because they could not drink the water from the river. [25] And seven full days passed after the LORD had struck the Nile.

8 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him that this is what the LORD says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [2] But if you refuse to let them go, I will plague your whole country with frogs. [3] The Nile will teem with frogs, and they will come into your palace and up to your bedroom and onto your bed, into the houses of your officials and your people, and into your ovens and kneading bowls. [4] "The frogs will come up on you and your people and all your officials.'" [5] And the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your hand with your staff over the rivers and canals and ponds, and cause the frogs to come up onto the land of Egypt.'" [6] So Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt, and the frogs came up and covered the land of Egypt. [7] But the magicians did the same thing by their magic arts, and they also brought frogs up onto the land of Egypt. [8] Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Pray to the LORD to take the frogs away from me and my people. Then I will let your people go, that they may sacrifice to the LORD." [9] Moses said to Pharaoh, "You may have the honor over me. When shall I pray for you and your officials and your people that the frogs (except for those in the Nile) may be taken away from you and your houses?"

[10] "Tomorrow," Pharaoh answered. "May it be as you say," Moses replied, "so that you may know that there is no one like the LORD our God." [11] "The frogs will depart from you and your houses and your officials and your people; they will remain only in the Nile." [12] After Moses and Aaron had left Pharaoh, Moses cried out to the LORD for help with the frogs that He had brought against Pharaoh. [13] And the LORD did as Moses requested, and the frogs in the houses, the courtyards, and the fields died. [14] They were piled into countless heaps, and there was a terrible stench in the land. [15] When Pharaoh saw that there was relief, however, he hardened his heart and would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said.

[16] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your staff and strike the dust of the earth, that it may turn into swarms of gnats throughout the land of Egypt.'" [17] This they did, and when Aaron stretched out his hand with his staff and struck the dust of the earth, gnats came upon man and beast. All the dust of the earth turned into gnats throughout the land of Egypt. [18] The magicians tried to produce gnats using their magic arts, but they could not. And the gnats remained on man and beast. [19] "This is the finger of God," the magicians said to Pharaoh. But Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said. [20] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning, and when Pharaoh goes out to the water, stand before him and tell him that this is what the LORD says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'"

[21] But if you will not let My people go, I will send swarms of flies upon you and your officials and your people and your houses. The houses of the Egyptians and even the ground where they stand will be full of flies. [22] But on that day I will give special treatment to the land of Goshen, where My people live; no swarms of flies will be found there. In this way you will know that I, the LORD, am in the land. [23] "I will make a distinction between My people and your people. This sign will take place tomorrow.'" [24] And the LORD did so. Thick swarms of flies poured into Pharaoh's palace and into the houses of his officials. Throughout Egypt the land was ruined by swarms of flies. [25] Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Go, sacrifice to your God within this land." [26] But Moses replied, "It would not be right to do that, because the sacrifices we offer to the LORD our God would be detestable to the Egyptians. If we offer sacrifices that are detestable before the Egyptians, will they not stone us?" [27] "We must make a three-day journey into the wilderness and sacrifice to the LORD our God as He commands us." [28] Pharaoh answered, "I will let you go and sacrifice to the LORD your God in the wilderness, but you must not go very far. Now pray for me." [29] "As soon as I leave you," Moses said, "I will pray to the LORD, so that tomorrow the swarms of flies will depart from Pharaoh and his officials and his people. But Pharaoh must not act deceitfully again by refusing to let the people go and sacrifice to the LORD." [30] Then Moses left Pharaoh and prayed to the LORD, [31] and the LORD did as Moses requested. He removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh and his officials and his people; not one fly remained. [32] But Pharaoh hardened his heart this time as well, and he would not let the people go.

9 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him that this is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [2] But if you continue to restrain them and refuse to let them go, [3] then the hand of the LORD will bring a severe plague on your livestock in the field—on your horses, donkeys, camels, herds, and flocks. [4] "But the LORD will make a distinction between the livestock of Israel and the livestock of Egypt, so that no animal belonging to the Israelites will die.'" [5] The LORD set a time, saying, "Tomorrow the LORD will do this in the land." [6] And the next day the LORD did just that. All the livestock of the Egyptians died, but not one animal belonging to the Israelites died. [7] Pharaoh sent officials and found that none of the livestock of the Israelites had died. But Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not let the people go. [8] Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "Take handfuls of soot from the furnace; in the sight of Pharaoh, Moses is to toss it into the air." [9] "It will become fine dust over all the land of Egypt, and festering boils will break out on man and beast throughout the land." [10] So they took soot from the furnace and stood before Pharaoh. Moses tossed it into the air, and festering boils broke out on man and beast.

[11] The magicians could not stand before Moses, because the boils had broken out on them and on all the Egyptians. [12] But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said to Moses. [13] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning, stand before Pharaoh, and tell him that this is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [14] Otherwise, I will send all My plagues against you and your officials and your people, so you may know that there is no one like Me in all the earth. [15] For by this time I could have stretched out My hand and struck you and your people with a plague to wipe you off the earth. [16] But I have raised you up for this very purpose, that I might display My power to you, and that My name might be proclaimed in all the earth. [17] Still, you lord it over My people and do not allow them to go.

[18] Behold, at this time tomorrow I will rain down the worst hail that has ever fallen on Egypt, from the day it was founded until now. [19] "So give orders now to shelter your livestock and everything you have in the field. Every man or beast that remains in the field and is not brought inside will die when the hail comes down upon them.'" [20] Those among Pharaoh's officials who feared the word of the LORD hurried to bring their servants and livestock to shelter, [21] but those who disregarded the word of the LORD left their servants and livestock in the field. [22] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward heaven, so that hail may fall on all the land of Egypt—on man and beast and every plant of the field throughout the land of Egypt."

[23] So Moses stretched out his staff toward heaven, and the LORD sent thunder and hail, and lightning struck the earth. So the LORD rained down hail upon the land of Egypt. [24] The hail fell and the lightning continued flashing through it. The hail was so severe that nothing like it had ever been seen in all the land of Egypt from the time it became a nation. [25] Throughout the land of Egypt, the hail struck down everything in the field, both man and beast; it beat down every plant of the field and stripped every tree. [26] The only place where it did not hail was in the land of Goshen, where the Israelites lived. [27] Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron. "This time I have sinned," he said. "The LORD is righteous, and I and my people are wicked." [28] "Pray to the LORD, for there has been enough of God's thunder and hail. I will let you go; you do not need to stay any longer." [29] Moses said to him, "When I have left the city, I will spread out my hands to the LORD. The thunder will cease, and there will be no more hail, so that you may know that the earth is the LORD's." [30] "But as for you and your officials, I know that you still do not fear the LORD our God." [31] (Now the flax and barley were destroyed, since the barley was ripe and the flax was in bloom; [32] but the wheat and spelt were not destroyed, because they are late crops.) [33] Then Moses departed from Pharaoh, went out of the city, and spread out his hands to the LORD. The thunder and hail ceased, and the rain no longer poured down on the land. [34] When Pharaoh saw that the rain and hail and thunder had ceased, he sinned again and hardened his heart—he and his officials. [35] So Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he would not let the Israelites go, just as the LORD had said through Moses.

10 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart and the hearts of his officials, that I may perform these miraculous signs of Mine among them," [2] "and that you may tell your children and grandchildren how severely I dealt with the Egyptians when I performed miraculous signs among them, so that all of you may know that I am the LORD." [3] So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and told him, "This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'How long will you refuse to humble yourself before Me? Let My people go, so that they may worship Me.'" [4] But if you refuse to let My people go, I will bring locusts into your territory tomorrow. [5] They will cover the face of the land so that no one can see it. They will devour whatever is left after the hail and eat every tree that grows in your fields. [6] "They will fill your houses and the houses of all your officials and every Egyptian—something neither your fathers nor your grandfathers have seen since the day they came into this land.'" Then Moses turned and left

Pharaoh's presence. 7 Pharaoh's officials asked him, "How long will this man be
a snare to us? Let the people go, so that they may worship the LORD their God.
Do you not yet realize that Egypt is in ruins?" 8 So Moses and Aaron were brought
back to Pharaoh. "Go, worship the LORD your God," he said. "But who exactly
will be going?"
9 "We will go with our young and old," Moses replied. "We will go with our
sons and daughters, and with our flocks and herds, for we must hold a feast to
the LORD." 10 Then Pharaoh told them, "May the LORD be with you if I ever
let you go with your little ones. Clearly you are bent on evil." 11 "No, only the men
may go and worship the LORD, since that is what you have been requesting." And
Moses and Aaron were driven from Pharaoh's presence.

12 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the land of Egypt, so
that the locusts may swarm over it and devour every plant in the land—everything
that the hail has left behind." 13 So Moses stretched out his staff over the land of
Egypt, and throughout that day and night the LORD sent an east wind across the
land. By morning the east wind had brought the locusts. 14 The locusts swarmed
across the land and settled over the entire territory of Egypt. Never before had there
been so many locusts, and never again will there be. 15 They covered the face of all
the land until it was black, and they consumed all the plants on the ground and all
the fruit on the trees that the hail had left behind. Nothing green was left on any tree
or plant in all the land of Egypt. 16 Pharaoh quickly summoned Moses and Aaron
and said, "I have sinned against the LORD your God and against you." 17 "Now
please forgive my sin once more and appeal to the LORD your God, that He may
remove this death from me." 18 So Moses left Pharaoh's presence and appealed to
the LORD.

19 And the LORD changed the wind to a very strong west wind that carried off the
locusts and blew them into the Red Sea. Not a single locust remained anywhere
in Egypt. 20 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let the
Israelites go. 21 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward
heaven, so that darkness may spread over the land of Egypt—a palpable darkness."
22 So Moses stretched out his hand toward heaven, and total darkness covered all the
land of Egypt for three days. 23 No one could see anyone else, and for three days no
one left his place. Yet all the Israelites had light in their dwellings. 24 Then Pharaoh
summoned Moses and said, "Go, worship the LORD. Even your little ones may go
with you; only your flocks and herds must stay behind." 25 But Moses replied, "You
must also provide us with sacrifices and burnt offerings to present to the LORD
our God." 26 "Even our livestock must go with us; not a hoof will be left behind, for
we will need some of them to worship the LORD our God, and we will not know
how we are to worship the LORD until we arrive." 27 But the LORD hardened
Pharaoh's heart, and he was unwilling to let them go. 28 "Depart from me!" Pharaoh
said to Moses. "Make sure you never see my face again, for on the day you see my
face, you will die." 29 "As you say," Moses replied, "I will never see your face again."

11 Then the LORD said to Moses, "I will bring upon Pharaoh and Egypt one
more plague. After that, he will allow you to leave this place. And when he lets you
go, he will drive you out completely." 2 "Now announce to the people that men
and women alike should ask their neighbors for articles of silver and gold." 3 And
the LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover, Moses
himself was highly regarded in Egypt by Pharaoh's officials and by the people.
4 So Moses declared, "This is what the LORD says: 'About midnight I will go
throughout Egypt,'" 5 and every firstborn son in the land of Egypt will die, from
the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne, to the firstborn of the servant girl
behind the hand mill, as well as the firstborn of all the cattle. 6 Then a great cry
will go out over all the land of Egypt. Such an outcry has never been heard before
and will never be heard again. 7 But among all the Israelites, not even a dog will
snarl at man or beast.' Then you will know that the LORD makes a distinction
between Egypt and Israel. 8 "And all these officials of yours will come and bow
before me, saying, 'Go, you and all the people who follow you!' After that, I will
depart." And hot with anger, Moses left Pharaoh's presence. 9 The LORD said to
Moses, "Pharaoh will not listen to you, so that My wonders may be multiplied in
the land of Egypt." 10 Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh, but
the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart so that he would not let the Israelites go out
of his land.

12 Now the LORD said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, 2 "This
month is the beginning of months for you; it shall be the first month of your year."
3 Tell the whole congregation of Israel that on the tenth day of this month each
man must select a lamb for his family, one per household. 4 If the household is too
small for a whole lamb, they are to share with the nearest neighbor based on the
number of people, and apportion the lamb accordingly. 5 Your lamb must be an
unblemished year-old male, and you may take it from the sheep or the goats. 6 You
must keep it until the fourteenth day of the month, when the whole assembly of
the congregation of Israel will slaughter the animals at twilight. 7 They are to take
some of the blood and put it on the sides and tops of the doorframes of the houses
where they eat the lambs. 8 They are to eat the meat that night, roasted over the
fire, along with unleavened bread and bitter herbs. 9 Do not eat any of the meat raw
or cooked in boiling water, but only roasted over the fire—its head and legs and
inner parts. 10 Do not leave any of it until morning; before the morning you must
burn up any part that is left over. 11 This is how you are to eat it: You must be fully
dressed for travel, with your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand. You
are to eat in haste; it is the LORD's Passover. 12 On that night I will pass through the
land of Egypt and strike down every firstborn male, both man and beast, and I will
execute judgment against all the gods of Egypt. I am the LORD. 13 The blood on the
houses where you are staying will distinguish them; when I see the blood, I will pass
over you. No plague will fall on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt.
14 And this day will be a memorial for you, and you are to celebrate it as a feast to
the LORD, as a permanent statute for the generations to come. 15 For seven days
you must eat unleavened bread. On the first day you are to remove the leaven from
your houses. Whoever eats anything leavened from the first day through the seventh
must be cut off from Israel. 16 On the first day you are to hold a sacred assembly,
and another on the seventh day. You must not do any work on those days, except
to prepare the meals—that is all you may do.
17 So you are to keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread, for on this very day I brought
your divisions out of the land of Egypt. You must keep this day as a permanent
statute for the generations to come. 18 In the first month you are to eat unleavened
bread, from the evening of the fourteenth day until the evening of the twenty-
first day. 19 For seven days there must be no leaven found in your houses. If anyone
eats something leavened, that person, whether a foreigner or native of the land, must
be cut off from the congregation of Israel. 20 "You are not to eat anything leavened;
eat unleavened bread in all your homes." 21 Then Moses summoned all the elders of
Israel and told them, "Go at once and select for yourselves a lamb for each family,
and slaughter the Passover lamb."

22 Take a cluster of hyssop, dip it into the blood in the basin, and brush the blood
on the top and sides of the doorframe. None of you shall go out the door of
his house until morning. 23 When the LORD passes through to strike down the
Egyptians, He will see the blood on the top and sides of the doorframe and will
pass over that doorway; so He will not allow the destroyer to enter your houses
and strike you down. 24 And you are to keep this command as a permanent statute
for you and your descendants. 25 When you enter the land that the LORD will
give you as He promised, you are to keep this service. 26 When your children ask
you, 'What does this service mean to you?' 27 "you are to reply, 'It is the Passover
sacrifice to the LORD, who passed over the houses of the Israelites in Egypt when
He struck down the Egyptians and spared our homes.'" Then the people bowed
down and worshiped. 28 And the Israelites went and did just what the LORD had
commanded Moses and Aaron. 29 Now at midnight the LORD struck down every
firstborn male in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat on his
throne, to the firstborn of the prisoner in the dungeon, as well as all the firstborn
among the livestock. 30 During the night Pharaoh got up—he and all his officials
and all the Egyptians—and there was loud wailing in Egypt; for there was no house
without someone dead. 31 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron by night
and said, "Get up, leave my people, both you and the Israelites! Go, worship the
LORD as you have requested." 32 "Take your flocks and herds as well, just as you
have said, and depart! And bless me also." 33 And in order to send them out of the
land quickly, the Egyptians urged the people on. "For otherwise," they said, "we are
all going to die!"

34 So the people took their dough before it was leavened, carrying it on their
shoulders in kneading bowls wrapped in clothing. 35 Furthermore, the Israelites
acted on Moses' word and asked the Egyptians for articles of silver and gold, and
for clothing. 36 And the LORD gave the people such favor in the sight of the
Egyptians that they granted their request. In this way they plundered the Egyptians.
37 The Israelites journeyed from Rameses to Succoth with about 600,000 men on
foot, besides women and children. 38 And a mixed multitude also went up with
them, along with great droves of livestock, both flocks and herds. 39 Since their
dough had no leaven, the people baked what they had brought out of Egypt into
unleavened loaves. For when they had been driven out of Egypt, they could not
delay and had not prepared any provisions for themselves. 40 Now the duration of
the Israelites' stay in Egypt was 430 years. 41 At the end of the 430 years, to the very
day, all the LORD's divisions went out of the land of Egypt. 42 Because the LORD
kept a vigil that night to bring them out of the land of Egypt, this same night is
to be a vigil to the LORD, to be observed by all the Israelites for the generations
to come. 43 And the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the statute of the
Passover: No foreigner is to eat of it." 44 But any slave who has been purchased may
eat of it, after you have circumcised him. 45 A temporary resident or hired hand
shall not eat the Passover. 46 It must be eaten inside one house. You are not to
take any of the meat outside the house, and you may not break any of the bones.
47 The whole congregation of Israel must celebrate it. 48 If a foreigner resides with
you and wants to celebrate the LORD's Passover, all the males in the household
must be circumcised; then he may come near to celebrate it, and he shall be like a
native of the land. But no uncircumcised man may eat of it. 49 "The same law shall
apply to both the native and the foreigner who resides among you." 50 Then all the
Israelites did this—they did just as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron.

51 And on that very day the LORD brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt
by their divisions.

13 Then the LORD said to Moses, 2 "Consecrate to Me every firstborn male.
The firstborn from every womb among the Israelites belongs to Me, both of man
and beast." 3 So Moses told the people, "Remember this day, the day you came out
of Egypt, out of the house of slavery; for the LORD brought you out of it by the
strength of His hand. And nothing leavened shall be eaten." 4 Today, in the month
of Abib, you are leaving. 5 And when the LORD brings you into the land of the
Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Hivites, and Jebusites—the land He swore to your
fathers that He would give you, a land flowing with milk and honey—you shall keep
this service in this month. 6 For seven days you are to eat unleavened bread, and on
the seventh day there shall be a feast to the LORD.

7 Unleavened bread shall be eaten during those seven days. Nothing leavened
may be found among you, nor shall leaven be found anywhere within your borders.
8 And on that day you are to explain to your son, 'This is because of what the LORD
did for me when I came out of Egypt.' 9 It shall be a sign for you on your hand and
a reminder on your forehead that the Law of the LORD is to be on your lips. For
with a mighty hand the LORD brought you out of Egypt.

10 Therefore you shall keep this statute at the appointed time year after year. 11 And
after the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanites and gives it to you, as
He swore to you and your fathers, 12 you are to present to the LORD the firstborn
male of every womb. All the firstborn males of your livestock belong to the LORD.
13 You must redeem every firstborn donkey with a lamb, and if you do not redeem
it, you are to break its neck. And every firstborn of your sons you must redeem.

14 In the future, when your son asks you, 'What does this mean?' you are to tell
him, 'With a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt, out of the house
of slavery.' 15 And when Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed
every firstborn in the land of Egypt, both of man and beast. This is why I sacrifice
to the LORD the firstborn male of every womb, but I redeem all the firstborn of
my sons.' 16 "So it shall serve as a sign on your hand and a symbol on your forehead,
for with a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt." 17 When Pharaoh
let the people go, God did not lead them along the road through the land of the
Philistines, though it was shorter. For God said, "If the people face war, they might
change their minds and return to Egypt." 18 So God led the people around by the
way of the wilderness toward the Red Sea. And the Israelites left the land of Egypt
arrayed for battle. 19 Moses took the bones of Joseph with him because Joseph had
made the sons of Israel swear a solemn oath when he said, "God will surely attend
to you, and then you must carry my bones with you from this place." 20 They set
out from Succoth and camped at Etham on the edge of the wilderness. 21 And the
LORD went before them in a pillar of cloud to guide their way by day, and in a
pillar of fire to give them light by night, so that they could travel by day or night.
22 Neither the pillar of cloud by day nor the pillar of fire by night left its place before
the people.

14 Then the LORD said to Moses, 2 "Tell the Israelites to turn back and encamp
before Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea. You are to encamp by the sea,
directly opposite Baal-zephon." 3 For Pharaoh will say of the Israelites, 'They are
wandering the land in confusion; the wilderness has boxed them in.' 4 "And I will
harden Pharaoh's heart so that he will pursue them. But I will gain honor by means
of Pharaoh and all his army, and the Egyptians will know that I am the LORD." So
this is what the Israelites did. 5 When the king of Egypt was told that the people had
fled, Pharaoh and his officials changed their minds about them and said, "What have
we done? We have released Israel from serving us." 6 So Pharaoh prepared his chariot
and took his army with him. 7 He took 600 of the best chariots, and all the other
chariots of Egypt, with officers over all of them. 8 And the LORD hardened the
heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt so that he pursued the Israelites, who were marching
out defiantly. 9 The Egyptians—all Pharaoh's horses and chariots, horsemen and
troops—pursued the Israelites and overtook them as they camped by the sea near
Pi-hahiroth, opposite Baal-zephon.

10 As Pharaoh approached, the Israelites looked up and saw the Egyptians
marching after them, and they were terrified and cried out to the LORD. 11 They
said to Moses, "Was it because there were no graves in Egypt that you brought us
into the wilderness to die? What have you done to us by bringing us out of Egypt?"
12 "Did we not say to you in Egypt, 'Leave us alone so that we may serve the
Egyptians'? For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die
in the wilderness." 13 But Moses told the people, "Do not be afraid. Stand firm and
you will see the LORD's salvation, which He will accomplish for you today; for the
Egyptians you see today, you will never see again." 14 "The LORD will fight for you;
you need only to be still."

15 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Why are you crying out to Me? Tell the
Israelites to go forward." 16 And as for you, lift up your staff and stretch out your
hand over the sea and divide it, so that the Israelites can go through the sea on
dry ground. 17 And I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians so that they will go
in after them. Then I will gain honor by means of Pharaoh and all his army and
chariots and horsemen. 18 "The Egyptians will know that I am the LORD when I
am honored through Pharaoh, his chariots, and his horsemen." 19 And the angel of
God, who had gone before the camp of Israel, withdrew and went behind them.
The pillar of cloud also moved from before them and stood behind them, 20 so
that it came between the camps of Egypt and Israel. The cloud was there in the
darkness, but it lit up the night. So all night long neither camp went near the other.
21 Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD
drove back the sea with a strong east wind that turned it into dry land. So the waters
were divided, 22 and the Israelites went through the sea on dry ground, with walls of
water on their right and on their left. 23 And the Egyptians chased after them—all
Pharaoh's horses, chariots, and horsemen—and followed them into the sea. 24 At
morning watch, however, the LORD looked down on the army of the Egyptians
from the pillar of fire and cloud, and He threw their camp into confusion. 25 He
caused their chariot wheels to wobble, so that they had difficulty driving. "Let us
flee from the Israelites," said the Egyptians, "for the LORD is fighting for them
against Egypt!" 26 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over
the sea, so that the waters may flow back over the Egyptians and their chariots
and horsemen." 27 So Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and at daybreak the
sea returned to its normal state. As the Egyptians were retreating, the LORD swept
them into the sea. 28 The waters flowed back and covered the chariots and horsemen
—the entire army of Pharaoh that had chased the Israelites into the sea. Not one of
them survived. 29 But the Israelites had walked through the sea on dry ground, with
walls of water on their right and on their left. 30 That day the LORD saved Israel
from the hand of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the shore.
31 When Israel saw the great power that the LORD had exercised over the Egyptians,
the people feared the LORD and believed in Him and in His servant Moses.

15 Then Moses and the Israelites sang this song to the LORD: "I will sing to the
LORD, for He is highly exalted. The horse and rider He has thrown into the sea."
2 The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation. He is
my God, and I will praise Him, my father's God, and I will exalt Him. 3 The LORD
is a warrior, the LORD is His name. 4 Pharaoh's chariots and army He has cast
into the sea; the finest of his officers are drowned in the Red Sea. 5 The depths have
covered them; they sank there like a stone. 6 Your right hand, O LORD, is majestic in
power; Your right hand, O LORD, has shattered the enemy. 7 You overthrew Your
adversaries by Your great majesty. You unleashed Your burning wrath; it consumed
them like stubble. 8 At the blast of Your nostrils the waters piled up; like a wall the
currents stood firm; the depths congealed in the heart of the sea.

9 The enemy declared, 'I will pursue, I will overtake. I will divide the spoils; I will
gorge myself on them. I will draw my sword; my hand will destroy them.' 10 But
You blew with Your breath, and the sea covered them. They sank like lead in the
mighty waters. 11 Who among the gods is like You, O LORD? Who is like You—
majestic in holiness, revered with praises, performing wonders? 12 You stretched out
Your right hand, and the earth swallowed them up. 13 With loving devotion You
will lead the people You have redeemed; with Your strength You will guide them
to Your holy dwelling. 14 The nations will hear and tremble; anguish will grip the
dwellers of Philistia.

15 Then the chiefs of Edom will be dismayed; trembling will seize the leaders
of Moab; those who dwell in Canaan will melt away, 16 and terror and dread will
fall on them. By the power of Your arm they will be as still as a stone until Your
people pass by, O LORD, until the people You have bought pass by. 17 You will
bring them in and plant them on the mountain of Your inheritance— the place, O
LORD, You have prepared for Your dwelling, the sanctuary, O Lord, Your hands
have established.

18 "The LORD will reign forever and ever!" 19 For when Pharaoh's horses, chariots,
and horsemen went into the sea, the LORD brought the waters of the sea back over
them. But the Israelites walked through the sea on dry ground. 20 Then Miriam
the prophetess, Aaron's sister, took a tambourine in her hand, and all the women
followed her with tambourines and dancing. 21 And Miriam sang back to them:
"Sing to the LORD, for He is highly exalted; the horse and rider He has thrown
into the sea." 22 Then Moses led Israel from the Red Sea, and they went out into
the Desert of Shur. For three days they walked in the desert without finding water.
23 And when they came to Marah, they could not drink the water there because it
was bitter. (That is why it was named Marah.) 24 So the people grumbled against
Moses, saying, "What are we to drink?" 25 And Moses cried out to the LORD,
and the LORD showed him a log. And when he cast it into the waters, they were
sweetened. There the LORD made for them a statute and an ordinance, and there
He tested them, 26 saying, "If you will listen carefully to the voice of the LORD
your God, and do what is right in His eyes, and pay attention to His commands,
and keep all His statutes, then I will not bring on you any of the diseases I inflicted
on the Egyptians. For I am the LORD who heals you." 27 Then they came to Elim,
where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees, and they camped
there by the waters.

16 On the fifteenth day of the second month after they had left the land of
Egypt, the whole congregation of Israel set out from Elim and came to the Desert
of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai. 2 And there in the desert they all grumbled
against Moses and Aaron. 3 "If only we had died by the LORD's hand in the land

of Egypt!" they said. "There we sat by pots of meat and ate our fill of bread, but you have brought us into this desert to starve this whole assembly to death!" [4] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Behold, I will rain down bread from heaven for you. Each day the people are to go out and gather enough for that day. In this way I will test whether or not they will follow My instructions." [5] "Then on the sixth day, when they prepare what they bring in, it will be twice as much as they gather on the other days." [6] So Moses and Aaron said to all the Israelites, "This evening you will know that it was the LORD who brought you out of the land of Egypt," [7] "and in the morning you will see the LORD's glory, because He has heard your grumbling against Him. For who are we that you should grumble against us?" [8] And Moses added, "The LORD will give you meat to eat this evening and bread to fill you in the morning, for He has heard your grumbling against Him. Who are we? Your grumblings are not against us but against the LORD." [9] Then Moses said to Aaron, "Tell the whole congregation of Israel, 'Come before the LORD, for He has heard your grumbling.'" [10] And as Aaron was speaking to the whole congregation of Israel, they looked toward the desert, and there in a cloud the glory of the LORD appeared. [11] Then the LORD said to Moses, [12] "I have heard the grumbling of the Israelites. Tell them, 'At twilight you will eat meat, and in the morning you will be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God.'" [13] That evening quail came and covered the camp, and in the morning there was a layer of dew around the camp. [14] When the layer of dew had evaporated, there were thin flakes on the desert floor, as fine as frost on the ground. [15] When the Israelites saw it, they asked one another, "What is it?" For they did not know what it was. So Moses told them, "It is the bread that the LORD has given you to eat." [16] "This is what the LORD has commanded: 'Each one is to gather as much as he needs. You may take an omer for each person in your tent.'" [17] So the Israelites did this. Some gathered more, and some less. [18] When they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much had no excess, and he who gathered little had no shortfall. Each one gathered as much as he needed to eat. [19] Then Moses said to them, "No one may keep any of it until morning." [20] But they did not listen to Moses; some people left part of it until morning, and it became infested with maggots and began to smell. So Moses was angry with them. [21] Every morning each one gathered as much as was needed, and when the sun grew hot, it melted away. [22] On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much food—two omers per person—and all the leaders of the congregation came and reported this to Moses. [23] He told them, "This is what the LORD has said: 'Tomorrow is to be a day of complete rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. So bake what you want to bake, and boil what you want to boil. Then set aside whatever remains and keep it until morning.'"

[24] So they set it aside until morning as Moses had commanded, and it did not smell or contain any maggots.

[25] "Eat it today," Moses said, "because today is a Sabbath to the LORD. Today you will not find anything in the field." [26] "For six days you may gather, but on the seventh day, the Sabbath, it will not be there." [27] Yet on the seventh day some of the people went out to gather, but they did not find anything. [28] Then the LORD said to Moses, "How long will you refuse to keep My commandments and instructions?" [29] "Understand that the LORD has given you the Sabbath; that is why on the sixth day He will give you bread for two days. On the seventh day, everyone must stay where he is; no one may leave his place." [30] So the people rested on the seventh day. [31] Now the house of Israel called the bread manna. It was white like coriander seed and tasted like wafers made with honey. [32] Moses said, "This is what the LORD has commanded: 'Keep an omer of manna for the generations to come, so that they may see the bread I fed you in the wilderness when I brought you out of the land of Egypt.'" [33] So Moses told Aaron, "Take a jar and fill it with an omer of manna. Then place it before the LORD to be preserved for the generations to come." [34] And Aaron placed it in front of the Testimony, to be preserved just as the LORD had commanded Moses. [35] The Israelites ate manna forty years, until they came to a land where they could settle; they ate manna until they reached the border of Canaan. [36] (Now an omer is a tenth of an ephah.)

17 Then the whole congregation of Israel left the Desert of Sin, moving from place to place as the LORD commanded. They camped at Rephidim, but there was no water for the people to drink. [2] So the people contended with Moses, "Give us water to drink." "Why do you contend with me?" Moses replied. "Why do you test the LORD?" [3] But the people thirsted for water there, and they grumbled against Moses: "Why have you brought us out of Egypt—to make us and our children and livestock die of thirst?" [4] Then Moses cried out to the LORD, "What should I do with these people? A little more and they will stone me!" [5] And the LORD said to Moses, "Walk on ahead of the people and take some of the elders of Israel with you. Take along in your hand the staff with which you struck the Nile, and go." [6] "Behold, I will stand there before you by the rock at Horeb. And when you strike the rock, water will come out of it for the people to drink." So Moses did this in the sight of the elders of Israel. [7] He named the place Massah and Meribah because the Israelites quarreled, and because they tested the LORD, saying, "Is the LORD among us or not?" [8] After this, the Amalekites came and attacked the Israelites at Rephidim.

[9] So Moses said to Joshua, "Choose some of our men and go out to fight the Amalekites. Tomorrow I will stand on the hilltop with the staff of God in my hand." [10] Joshua did as Moses had instructed him and fought against the Amalekites, while Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. [11] As long as Moses held up his hands, Israel prevailed; but when he lowered them, Amalek prevailed. [12] When Moses' hands grew heavy, they took a stone and put it under him, and he sat on it. Then Aaron and Hur held his hands up, one on each side, so that his hands remained steady until the sun went down. [13] So Joshua overwhelmed Amalek and his army with the sword. [14] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Write this on a scroll as a reminder and recite it to Joshua, because I will utterly blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven." [15] And Moses built an altar and named it The LORD Is My Banner. [16] "Indeed," he said, "a hand was lifted up toward the throne of the LORD. The LORD will war against Amalek from generation to generation."

18 Now Moses' father-in-law Jethro, the priest of Midian, heard about all that God had done for Moses and His people Israel, and how the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt. [2] After Moses had sent back his wife Zipporah, his father-in-law Jethro had received her, [3] along with her two sons. One son was named Gershom, for Moses had said, "I have been a foreigner in a foreign land." [4] The other son was named Eliezer, for Moses had said, "The God of my father was my helper and delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh." [5] Moses' father-in-law Jethro, along with Moses' wife and sons, came to him in the desert, where he was encamped at the mountain of God. [6] He sent word to Moses, "I, your father-in-law Jethro, am coming to you with your wife and her two sons." [7] So Moses went out to meet his father-in-law and bowed down and kissed him. They greeted each other and went into the tent. [8] Then Moses recounted to his father-in-law all that the LORD had done to Pharaoh and the Egyptians for Israel's sake, all the hardships they had encountered along the way, and how the LORD had delivered them.

[9] And Jethro rejoiced over all the good things the LORD had done for Israel, whom He had rescued from the hand of the Egyptians. [10] Jethro declared, "Blessed be the LORD, who has delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians and of Pharaoh, and who has delivered the people from the hand of the Egyptians." [11] "Now I know that the LORD is greater than all other gods, for He did this when they treated Israel with arrogance." [12] Then Moses' father-in-law Jethro brought a burnt offering and sacrifices to God, and Aaron came with all the elders of Israel to eat bread with Moses' father-in-law in the presence of God. [13] The next day Moses took his seat to judge the people, and they stood around him from morning until evening. [14] When his father-in-law saw all that Moses was doing for the people, he asked, "What is this that you are doing for the people? Why do you sit alone as judge, with all the people standing around you from morning till evening?" [15] "Because the people come to me to inquire of God," Moses replied. [16] "Whenever they have a dispute, it is brought to me to judge between one man and another, and I make known to them the statutes and laws of God."

[17] But Moses' father-in-law said to him, "What you are doing is not good."

[18] Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone. [19] Now listen to me; I will give you some advice, and may God be with you. You must be the people's representative before God and bring their causes to Him. [20] Teach them the statutes and laws, and show them the way to live and the work they must do. [21] Furthermore, select capable men from among the people—God-fearing, trustworthy men who are averse to dishonest gain. Appoint them over the people as leaders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens. [22] Have these men judge the people at all times. Then they can bring you any major issue, but all minor cases they can judge on their own, so that your load may be lightened as they share it with you. [23] "If you follow this advice and God so directs you, then you will be able to endure, and all these people can go home in peace." [24] Moses listened to his father-in-law and did everything he said. [25] So Moses chose capable men from all Israel and made them heads over the people as leaders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens. [26] And they judged the people at all times; they would bring the difficult cases to Moses, but any minor issue they would judge themselves. [27] Then Moses sent his father-in-law on his way, and Jethro returned to his own land.

19 In the third month, on the same day of the month that the Israelites had left the land of Egypt, they came to the Wilderness of Sinai. [2] After they had set out from Rephidim, they entered the Wilderness of Sinai, and Israel camped there in front of the mountain. [3] Then Moses went up to God, and the LORD called to him from the mountain, "This is what you are to tell the house of Jacob and explain to the sons of Israel:" [4] 'You have seen for yourselves what I did to Egypt, and how I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to Myself. [5] Now if you will indeed obey My voice and keep My covenant, you will be My treasured possession out of all the nations—for the whole earth is Mine. [6] "And unto Me you shall be a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.' These are the words that you are to speak to the Israelites." [7] So Moses went back and summoned the elders of the people and set before them all these words that the LORD had commanded him.

[8] And all the people answered together, "We will do everything that the LORD has spoken." So Moses brought their words back to the LORD. [9] The LORD said to Moses, "Behold, I will come to you in a dense cloud, so that the people will hear

when I speak with you, and they will always put their trust in you." And Moses relayed to the LORD what the people had said. [10] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to the people and consecrate them today and tomorrow. They must wash their clothes" [11] and be prepared by the third day, for on the third day the LORD will come down on Mount Sinai in the sight of all the people. [12] And you are to set up a boundary for the people around the mountain and tell them, 'Be careful not to go up on the mountain or touch its base. Whoever touches the mountain shall surely be put to death.' [13] "No hand shall touch him, but he shall surely be stoned or shot with arrows—whether man or beast, he must not live.' Only when the ram's horn sounds a long blast may they approach the mountain." [14] When Moses came down from the mountain to the people, he consecrated them, and they washed their clothes.

[15] "Be prepared for the third day," he said to the people. "Do not draw near to a woman."

[16] On the third day, when morning came, there was thunder and lightning. A thick cloud was upon the mountain, and a very loud blast of the ram's horn went out, so that all the people in the camp trembled. [17] Then Moses brought the people out of the camp to meet with God, and they stood at the foot of the mountain. [18] Mount Sinai was completely enveloped in smoke, because the LORD had descended on it in fire. And the smoke rose like the smoke of a furnace, and the whole mountain quaked violently. [19] And as the sound of the ram's horn grew louder and louder, Moses spoke and God answered him in the thunder. [20] The LORD descended to the top of Mount Sinai and called Moses to the summit. So Moses went up, [21] and the LORD said to him, "Go down and warn the people not to break through to see the LORD, lest many of them perish." [22] "Even the priests who approach the LORD must consecrate themselves, or the LORD will break out against them." [23] But Moses said to the LORD, "The people cannot come up Mount Sinai, for You solemnly warned us, 'Put a boundary around the mountain and set it apart as holy.'" [24] And the LORD replied, "Go down and bring Aaron with you. But the priests and the people must not break through to come up to the LORD, or He will break out against them." [25] So Moses went down to the people and spoke to them.

20 And God spoke all these words: [2] "I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery." [3] You shall have no other gods before Me. [4] You shall not make for yourself an idol in the form of anything in the heavens above, on the earth below, or in the waters beneath. [5] You shall not bow down to them or worship them; for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on their children to the third and fourth generations of those who hate Me, [6] but showing loving devotion to a thousand generations of those who love Me and keep My commandments. [7] You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain, for the LORD will not leave anyone unpunished who takes His name in vain.

[8] Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. [9] Six days you shall labor and do all your work, [10] but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God, on which you must not do any work—neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant or livestock, nor the foreigner within your gates. [11] For in six days the LORD made the heavens and the earth and the sea and all that is in them, but on the seventh day He rested. Therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day and set it apart as holy. [12] Honor your father and mother, so that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you. [13] You shall not murder. [14] You shall not commit adultery. [15] You shall not steal. [16] You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor.

[17] "You shall not covet your neighbor's house. You shall not covet your neighbor's wife, or his manservant or maidservant, or his ox or donkey, or anything that belongs to your neighbor."

[18] When all the people witnessed the thunder and lightning, the sounding of the ram's horn, and the mountain enveloped in smoke, they trembled and stood at a distance. [19] "Speak to us yourself and we will listen," they said to Moses. "But do not let God speak to us, or we will die." [20] "Do not be afraid," Moses replied. "For God has come to test you, so that the fear of Him may be before you, to keep you from sinning." [21] And the people stood at a distance as Moses approached the thick darkness where God was. [22] Then the LORD said to Moses, "This is what you are to tell the Israelites: 'You have seen for yourselves that I have spoken to you from heaven.'" [23] You are not to make any gods alongside Me; you are not to make for yourselves gods of silver or gold. [24] You are to make for Me an altar of earth, and sacrifice on it your burnt offerings and peace offerings, your sheep and goats and cattle. In every place where I cause My name to be remembered, I will come to you and bless you. [25] Now if you make an altar of stones for Me, you must not build it with stones shaped by tools; for if you use a chisel on it, you will defile it. [26] And you must not go up to My altar on steps, lest your nakedness be exposed on it.'

21 "These are the ordinances that you are to set before them:" [2] If you buy a Hebrew servant, he is to serve you for six years. But in the seventh year, he shall go free without paying anything. [3] If he arrived alone, he is to leave alone; if he arrived with a wife, she is to leave with him. [4] If his master gives him a wife and she bears him sons or daughters, the woman and her children shall belong to her master, and only the man shall go free. [5] But if the servant declares, 'I love my master and my wife and children; I do not want to go free,' [6] then his master is to bring him before the judges. And he shall take him to the door or doorpost and pierce his ear with an awl. Then he shall serve his master for life. [7] And if a man sells his daughter as a servant, she is not to go free as the menservants do. [8] If she is displeasing in the eyes of her master who had designated her for himself, he must allow her to be redeemed. He has no right to sell her to foreigners, since he has broken faith with her. [9] And if he chooses her for his son, he must deal with her as with a daughter. [10] If he takes another wife, he must not reduce the food, clothing, or marital rights of his first wife. [11] If, however, he does not provide her with these three things, she is free to go without monetary payment.

[12] Whoever strikes and kills a man must surely be put to death. [13] If, however, he did not lie in wait, but God allowed it to happen, then I will appoint for you a place where he may flee. [14] But if a man schemes and acts willfully against his neighbor to kill him, you must take him away from My altar to be put to death. [15] Whoever strikes his father or mother must surely be put to death.

[16] Whoever kidnaps another man must be put to death, whether he sells him or the man is found in his possession. [17] Anyone who curses his father or mother must surely be put to death. [18] If men are quarreling and one strikes the other with a stone or a fist, and he does not die but is confined to bed, [19] then the one who struck him shall go unpunished, as long as the other can get up and walk around outside with his staff. Nevertheless, he must compensate the man for his lost work and see that he is completely healed. [20] If a man strikes his manservant or maidservant with a rod, and the servant dies by his hand, he shall surely be punished. [21] However, if the servant gets up after a day or two, the owner shall not be punished, since the servant is his property. [22] If men who are fighting strike a pregnant woman and her child is born prematurely, but there is no further injury, he shall surely be fined as the woman's husband demands and as the court allows. [23] But if a serious injury results, then you must require a life for a life—

[24] eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot, [25] burn for burn, wound for wound, and stripe for stripe. [26] If a man strikes and blinds the eye of his manservant or maidservant, he must let the servant go free as compensation for the eye. [27] And if he knocks out the tooth of his manservant or maidservant, he must let the servant go free as compensation for the tooth. [28] If an ox gores a man or woman to death, the ox must surely be stoned, and its meat must not be eaten. But the owner of the ox shall not be held responsible. [29] But if the ox has a habit of goring, and its owner has been warned yet does not restrain it, and it kills a man or woman, then the ox must be stoned and its owner must also be put to death. [30] If payment is demanded of him instead, he may redeem his life by paying the full amount demanded of him. [31] If the ox gores a son or a daughter, it shall be done to him according to the same rule. [32] If the ox gores a manservant or maidservant, the owner must pay thirty shekels of silver to the master of that servant, and the ox must be stoned. [33] If a man opens or digs a pit and fails to cover it, and an ox or a donkey falls into it, [34] the owner of the pit shall make restitution; he must pay its owner, and the dead animal will be his. [35] If a man's ox injures his neighbor's ox and it dies, they must sell the live one and divide the proceeds; they also must divide the dead animal. [36] But if it was known that the ox had a habit of goring, yet its owner failed to restrain it, he shall pay full compensation, ox for ox, and the dead animal will be his.

22 "If a man steals an ox or a sheep and slaughters or sells it, he must repay five oxen for an ox and four sheep for a sheep." [2] If a thief is caught breaking in and is beaten to death, no one shall be guilty of bloodshed. [3] But if it happens after sunrise, there is guilt for his bloodshed. A thief must make full restitution; if he has nothing, he himself shall be sold for his theft. [4] If what was stolen is actually found alive in his possession—whether ox or donkey or sheep—he must pay back double. [5] If a man grazes his livestock in a field or vineyard and allows them to stray so that they graze in someone else's field, he must make restitution from the best of his own field or vineyard. [6] If a fire breaks out and spreads to thornbushes so that it consumes stacked or standing grain, or the whole field, the one who started the fire must make full restitution. [7] If a man gives his neighbor money or goods for safekeeping and they are stolen from the neighbor's house, the thief, if caught, must pay back double. [8] If the thief is not found, the owner of the house must appear before the judges to determine whether he has taken his neighbor's property. [9] In all cases of illegal possession of an ox, a donkey, a sheep, a garment, or any lost item that someone claims, 'This is mine,' both parties shall bring their cases before the judges. The one whom the judges find guilty must pay back double to his neighbor.

[10] If a man gives a donkey, an ox, a sheep, or any other animal to be cared for by his neighbor, but it dies or is injured or stolen while no one is watching, [11] an oath before the LORD shall be made between the parties to determine whether or not the man has taken his neighbor's property. The owner must accept the oath and require no restitution. [12] But if the animal was actually stolen from the neighbor, he must make restitution to the owner. [13] If the animal was torn to pieces, he shall bring it as evidence; he need not make restitution for the torn carcass.

[14] If a man borrows an animal from his neighbor and it is injured or dies while its
owner is not present, he must make full restitution. [15] If the owner was present, no
restitution is required. If the animal was rented, the fee covers the loss. [16] If a man
seduces a virgin who is not pledged in marriage and sleeps with her, he must pay
the full dowry for her to be his wife. [17] If her father absolutely refuses to give her to
him, the man still must pay an amount comparable to the bridal price of a virgin.
[18] You must not allow a sorceress to live. [19] Whoever lies with an animal must surely
be put to death.

[20] If anyone sacrifices to any god other than the LORD alone, he must be set
apart for destruction. [21] You must not exploit or oppress a foreign resident, for you
yourselves were foreigners in the land of Egypt. [22] You must not mistreat any widow
or orphan. [23] If you do mistreat them, and they cry out to Me in distress, I will surely
hear their cry. [24] My anger will be kindled, and I will kill you with the sword; then
your wives will become widows and your children will be fatherless. [25] If you lend
money to one of My people among you who is poor, you must not act as a creditor
to him; you are not to charge him interest.

TIRA-CONTROL: BLK-003 · CUADERNILLO 1/1